

Raw notes - Social reconnection interview 1

- Interviewer: Oleh Goumain
- Notetaker: Jiawen Li
- Interview date, time, and time zone: 09/28/2026, 1:15 pm EDT
- Participant: Shawneece Garrett, junior who joined a campus club this fall and met people through it and a study group; fits because she recently met several acquaintances who are not close friends
- Permission to take notes: "Of course."

Questions and participant's words

1. **Context:** "There's a girl from my econ study group, Priya, we got along well. We follow each other on Instagram and sometimes react to each other's stories. That's pretty much it."
2. **Hardest part or what works well:** "Honestly I don't have a reason to message. We're not in the same class anymore, so there's nothing to say, and a random 'hey' feels like a lot."
3. **Last specific incident, how it happened, frequency, and consequence:** "Last week I saw Priya post from a concert and thought, I should say hi. I opened the DM, typed 'omg looks fun,' deleted it, and never sent it. I think that happens with people from the club or my classes a couple of times a month. Nothing bad happens, I just lose touch. Priya and I had been pretty close to being real friends, so it matters a little."
4. **Current approach and how well it works:** "Story reacts and likes. It keeps me visible, but it never turns into an actual conversation." (approximate paraphrase of the second sentence)
5. **Money spent specifically on this problem:** "No." (She mentioned paying for extra iCloud storage; the interviewer did not count it.)
6. **First reaction to the concept, after section 4:** "Oh, that's kind of nice actually. Like a photo from the club retreat, and then I send it to someone who was there."
7. **Biggest concern:** "It looking at my whole camera roll. I'd only want it to use a folder I pick."
8. **Referral and follow-up response:** "I could ask Jordan from my club, he's new this year too." (approximate paraphrase) "Yeah, you can follow up."
9. **Other comments or follow-ups actually asked:**
 - Asked: "What stopped you that time?" Shawneece: "I didn't want it to be weird, like why am I suddenly messaging you. A photo would've been a reason."
 - Asked: "When did you last revisit an old photo? What did you do next?" Shawneece: "Snapchat Memories showed me one from the retreat last week. I sent it to my roommate, but she's a close friend, not someone like Priya."

Interviewer observations, separate from their words

Shawniece smiled when describing the club retreat photo and responded faster to the concept than to earlier questions. She grew quieter when talking about the unsent DM. (Interpretation, mine: she already resurfaces photos on her own, but only sends them to close friends.)

Skipped questions

None.